



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Let me tell you about my trip!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Would you like to go to China? Why or why not?
- What other places would you like to visit? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about beliefs, opinions, relationships and character traits.
- I can say and use words like *legacy, philosophy, employee, classic, identify, Armenian, petition, decision, Japanese* and *engineer*.

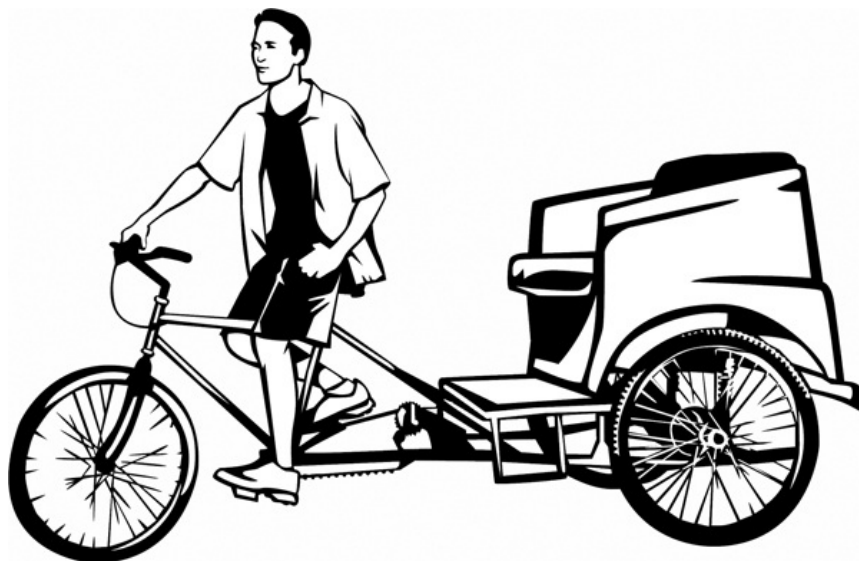




Let's Explore!

Paula Timbers gives a speech about her trip to China. She loved the **ambiance***!

* The "*ambiance*" of a place is the feeling or mood it gives you. It is originally a French word.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Hear ye! Hear ye! Friends, Romans, Countrymen! Lend me your ears! My name is Paula Timbers and I am so happy to be here giving my first Toastmasters address. I would like to give a special thanks to my friend Howard Taylor who signed my petition to join the club. Today I would like to talk to you about my recent trip to China. I went with three other brave employees from my office. I am convinced that going on this trip was a great decision. In preparation for the trip, I read several histories of China and also learned about Chinese language and philosophy. In my opinion, the best language course out there is the classic series called *Getting By in Chinese*. I combed through several travel guidebooks for pictures of some major landmarks to be able to identify them when I got there. When I arrived in Beijing, I found that the legacy of Chairman Mao is prominent everywhere. I walked around for nearly an hour and a half, soaking up the **ambiance** of the busy streets, buildings and traffic. As a Canadian traffic engineer, I was fascinated to see horses, pedicabs and cars parked on sidewalks, and every kind of transport you could imagine on the side streets. You have to be adaptable to get around in China. Then there is Tiananmen Square — a public square larger than any other in the world. Ninety football fields would fit inside it. When I was there, it was filled with soccer players, kite-flyers and of course all kinds of people who were just out for a walk. I stopped for a while and chatted with a couple who told me they were students. I suspect they wanted to practice their English. They said they studied art and calligraphy. I was interested, so they kindly invited me to look at their work. What an experience!





Let's Practice!

Can you remember the suffixes stress rules?

Instructions: Match the two halves to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1) I would like to give a special thanks to my good friend Howard Taylor who signed | a) ___ and philosophy. |
| 2) I learned about Chinese language | b) ___ I was fascinated to see horses, pedicabs, and cars parked on sidewalks. |
| 3) I also read through several travel guidebooks | c) ___ to be able to identify some major landmarks. |
| 4) I saw that the legacy of Chairman Mao | d) ___ my petition to join the club. |
| 5) As a Canadian traffic engineer, | e) ___ is prominent everywhere. |



Let's Practice!

You can learn a lot from other cultures.

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

pedicabs / my opinion / traffic engineer / Lend me your ears / adaptable / clear sign / believe / maintain / In my view

- 1) _____ ! I _____ we should stay together.
- 2) In _____ as a Canadian _____, Chinese transportation is recursive.
- 3) Chinese are very creative, the _____ are a _____ of it.
- 4) I _____ you have to be _____ to get around in China.
- 5) _____, we could create transportation systems with very low carbon footprint.





Extension Activity

Prepare a speech about a trip you went on.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about an interesting trip you went on. It can be a trip to a different country or a trip to a place in your city or country. Include lots of details about what you saw and experienced.
- Write a speech of 100 - 120 words you could give to a Toastmaster's Club meeting.
- Start your speech with an introduction like Hear ye! Hear ye! Friends, Romans, Countrymen! Lend me your ears! or It's nice to see so many familiar faces in the crowd.
- Proofread your speech for correct spelling and punctuation.
- Read your speech to a partner or a group.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a speech about a trip I went on.

☐
☐

I use an appropriate introduction for a speech.

☐
☐

I read my speech to a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- Friends, Romans, Countrymen** (expression): in history, a call public speakers used to get the attention of the people around them
e.g. Hear ye! Hear ye! Friends, Romans, Countrymen!
- lend me your ears** (expression): please listen to me
e.g. Friends, Romans, Countrymen! Lend me your ears!
- traffic engineer** (noun): a profession which involves the design and construction of roads
e.g. As a Canadian traffic engineer, I was fascinated to see horses and cars parked on sidewalks.
- pedicab** (noun): a three-wheeled human-powered vehicle, common in Southeast Asia
e.g. It was interesting to see pedicabs used as a manner of transportation.
- adaptable** (adjective): able to change when necessary
e.g. You have to be adaptable to get around in China.
- public square** (noun): a large open space in an urban center with buildings on four sides
e.g. Then there is Tiananmen Square — a public square larger than any other in the world.





Learning Points

Stress with Suffixes

You can learn how to pronounce new words more easily if you know some simple rules about suffixes and word stress.

You can learn how to stress a word by paying attention to the rules for certain suffixes. A suffix is the ending of a word that adds meaning to that word. Knowing the meaning of suffixes can increase your vocabulary and help you to express yourself in different ways, using different words.

Let's look at the following suffixes and their pronunciation rules for word stress.

You should stress 1 syllable before the suffix for words ending in:

-ic
-tion/ -sion

generic	ge <u>ne</u> ric
epidemic	e pi <u>de</u> mic
consumption	con <u>sump</u> tion
expansion	ex <u>pan</u> sion
regulation	reg u <u>la</u> tion
hypertension	hy per <u>ten</u> sion

In words ending with **-cy**, **-ty**, **-phy**, **-fy**, and **-ian**, you need to stress 2 syllables before the suffix:

legacy	<u>le</u> ga cy
pregnancy	<u>preg</u> nan cy
reality	re <u>a</u> li ty
punctuality	punc tu <u>a</u> li ty
geography	ge <u>o</u> gra phy
biography	bi <u>o</u> gra phy
classify	<u>cla</u> ssi fy
personify	per <u>son</u> i fy
musician	<u>mu</u> si cian
obstetrician	obs <u>te</u> tri cian

You need to stress the syllable on the suffix for words ending in:

-ee
-eer
-ese





Learning Points

oversee	o ver <u>see</u>
employee	em ploy <u>ee</u>
engineer	en gi <u>neer</u>
pioneer	pi o <u>neer</u>
Japanese	Ja pa <u>nese</u>
Portuguese	Por tu <u>guese</u>

What other words do you know with these suffix endings?

Examples:

- *I went with three other brave employees from my office.*
- *In my opinion, the best language course out there is the classic series called "Getting By in Chinese".*

